被拒绝了十二次的哈利·波特

The Book Twelve Publishers Turned Down



十二次拒绝后，一位八岁读者带来了什么转机？

英文原文

In 1990, on a **delayed** train from **Manchester** to London's King's Cross, Joanne Rowling, a **would-be novelist**, was **unexpectedly** struck by the **inspiration** for Harry Potter, an **orphaned** young **wizard**. **Grief** soon **overshadowed** that **spark**: her mother died on 30 December 1990, aged 45. Rowling then **relocated** to Porto to teach English.

Rowling married in Porto in October 1992, and a daughter's **arrival** in July 1993 **ushered in motherhood**. At the end of 1993 she **resettled** in **Edinburgh**, a **lone** mother **reliant on** state **welfare**. She **habitually** wrote in cafés, **patiently polishing** her **unfinished** novel.

A **literary** agent, Christopher Little, **took on** the manuscript and **pitched** it **repeatedly** to **prospective** buyers. It was reportedly **rejected** by twelve publishers **in succession**, a **relentless** run of **refusals** that offered the **newcomer** little **encouragement**.

At Bloomsbury, the **chairman** Nigel Newton gave the first **chapter** to his eight-year-old daughter, Alice, who **relished** it and **eagerly** asked for the next **instalment**. The firm paid **a sum of** 1,500 pounds **as an advance**. **Fearful** that boys might **disregard** a book by a woman, the publishers **opted for initials** to **mask** her **gender**. Having no middle name, Rowling took the K for her **pseudonym** from her grandmother Kathleen.

Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone was published on 26 June 1997, in a **cautious** first print run of 500 **hardbacks**, 300 **allocated** to libraries. The American publisher Scholastic paid $105,000 for the US rights, and the **renamed** Sorcerer's Stone appeared there on 1 September 1998. The **series** and its **spin-off volumes** have **collectively surpassed** 500 million copies sold, in 80 languages. Alice's **appetite** was **evidently** shared by millions.

中文译文

1990年，在一列晚点的列车上，这列车从曼彻斯特开往伦敦国王十字车站，乔安妮·罗琳，一位有志成为小说家的人，出乎意料地得到了哈利·波特的灵感，哈利是一个成为孤儿的少年巫师。悲痛很快就盖过了那点火花：她的母亲于1990年12月30日去世，终年45岁。罗琳随后移居到波尔图，教英语。

罗琳于1992年10月在波尔图结婚；而1993年7月，女儿的降生开启/迎来了她为人母的生活。1993年底，她重新安家在爱丁堡，成了一位独自带孩子的母亲，依靠国家福利生活。她习惯在咖啡馆里写作，耐心地打磨她那部尚未完成的小说。

文学经纪人克里斯托弗·利特尔接下了这部书稿，并多次把它推销给潜在的买家。书稿据报道接连遭到十二家出版社拒绝，这一连串毫不留情的回绝，没给这位新人多少鼓励。

在布卢姆斯伯里出版社，董事长奈杰尔·牛顿把第一章交给了他八岁的女儿爱丽丝，她十分享受读这部小说，还急切地要看下一部分。这家出版社支付了一笔1,500英镑的款项作为预付金。由于担心男孩们可能会忽视女性写的书，出版方选择用名字缩写来掩饰/隐瞒她的性别。由于没有中间名，罗琳把 K用作她笔名的一部分，它取自祖母凯瑟琳的名字。

《哈利·波特与魔法石》（Philosopher's Stone）于1997年6月26日出版，首印十分谨慎，仅为500册精装本，其中300册分配给了图书馆。美国的学乐出版社以105,000美元买下了美国版权，而更名后的《魔法石》于1998年9月1日在那里问世。这个系列及其衍生的图书合计已超过了5亿册的销量，翻译成80种语言。爱丽丝的这份胃口，显然在数百万人中引发了共鸣。

词汇与表达

delayed adj.
晚点的

Manchester n.
曼彻斯特

would-be adj.
有志成为

novelist n.
小说家

unexpectedly adv.
出乎意料地

inspiration n.
灵感
the inspiration for Harry Potter

orphaned adj.
成为孤儿的

wizard n.
巫师

Grief n.
悲痛
Grief soon overshadowed that spark

overshadowed v.
盖过了
overshadowed that spark

spark n.
火花

relocated v.
移居
relocated to Porto

arrival n.
降生

ushered in v.
开启/迎来了
ushered in motherhood

motherhood n.
为人母

resettled v.
重新安家

Edinburgh n.
爱丁堡

lone adj.
独自

reliant on adj.
依靠
reliant on state welfare

welfare n.
福利
state welfare

词汇与表达（续）

habitually adv.
习惯

patiently adv.
耐心地

polishing v.
打磨
polishing her unfinished novel

unfinished adj.
尚未完成的

literary adj.
文学
A literary agent

took on phr.
接下了

pitched v.
推销
pitched it repeatedly

repeatedly adv.
多次

prospective adj.
潜在的
prospective buyers

rejected v.
拒绝
rejected by twelve publishers

in succession n.
接连
twelve publishers in succession

relentless adj.
毫不留情的

refusals n.
回绝

newcomer n.
新人

encouragement n.
鼓励

chairman n.
董事长

chapter n.
章

relished v.
十分享受
who relished it

eagerly adv.
急切地

instalment n.
部分

词汇与表达（续）

a sum of n.
一笔……款项

as an advance n.
作为预付金

Fearful adj.
担心

disregard v.
忽视
disregard a book by a woman

opted for v.
选择
opted for initials

initials n.
名字缩写
initials to mask her gender

mask v.
掩饰/隐瞒

gender n.
性别

pseudonym n.
笔名
the K for her pseudonym

cautious adj.
谨慎

hardbacks n.
精装本
first print run of 500 hardbacks

allocated v.
分配
300 allocated to libraries

renamed v.
更名后的

series n.
系列

spin-off n.
衍生的

volumes n.
图书

collectively adv.
合计
have collectively surpassed

surpassed v.
超过了
surpassed 500 million copies sold

appetite n.
胃口

evidently adv.
显然

文章简述

- 起笔：1990年，罗琳在一列晚点火车上得到哈利·波特的灵感，开始构思孤儿巫师的故事。
- 坚持：经历丧母后，她在爱丁堡独自抚养女儿，依靠福利生活，仍常在咖啡馆打磨小说。
- 转机：书稿据报遭十二家出版社拒绝；布卢姆斯伯里董事长的八岁女儿爱丽丝，读首章后急着看后续。
- 问世：该社接纳书稿，因担心男孩忽略女作者的书，采用J.K.缩写署名；1997年首册《魔法石》在英国首印500册精装本。
- 回响：美国版于1998年问世；系列及衍生图书后来已有80种语言版本，合计销量超过五亿册。